

FORGE Phase 2 · Week 14 · Session 40 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 40: How Adults Learn" in the Phase 2 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 40 as written runs about 95 minutes. This insert adds an opening video, a video on Knowles' four principles, and one talk about what young people behind bars can teach the people who teach them, which fills the session to two hours.

What's in this insert

- **Video 40A, "How Adults Learn"** (1 min 45 s). The bridge from Week 13, in the guide's words: the mentor who knows the material, lectures for an hour straight and walks away saying "they just don't care"; "The problem isn't the audience. The problem is the delivery."; knowing something and being able to teach it are two completely different skills; and what today holds. It ends on the guide's check-in question, *How are you doing today? Think back to Phase 1: what was the most effective session? Not your favorite topic. The session where you actually learned the most. What made it work?*, and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 40B, "Knowles' Four Principles"** (1 min 53 s). The four principles one at a time, each with the guide's "what this means for you": answer "Why should I care?" before you teach anything; not "talk about it," do it; the problem comes first; and something to use tonight, with FORGE's own homework as the example. It ends on the four principles and "Now connect each one to your own experience."
- **A talk on learners the teaching failed:** Hilderbrand Pelzer III, *What incarcerated youth can teach teachers* (TEDxDeerPark, 18 minutes 11 seconds). Pelzer is a former principal of a public school inside one of the country's largest urban jail systems. TED sums the talk up as: "What if new teacher preparation and ongoing professional development programs used incarcerated youth as 'thought partners' to help overcome the challenges of teaching reading?" It sets up the closing question and the guide's closing words: most of you were failed by people who didn't know how to teach you, not because you couldn't learn.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 40A	2	Play it first, with the room already in a circle. It carries the Week 13 bridge and ends on the check-in question; go straight into the round.
0:02	Opening circle	10	As written. Listen for what made a session work; the answers foreshadow Knowles' principles, so note them.
0:12	Bridge from Week 13	5	The video gave the bridge. Say it once more in your own words, briefly, and tie it to two or three of the check-in answers.
0:17	Video 40B , then Knowles' 4 Principles of Adult Learning	30	Play the video at the start of the segment (2 minutes). It names each principle; your job is the connection to the men's own experience: the Week 2 thinking-errors example, the 2–3 responses, and the quick review where four men give the principles back in their own words.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:47	Learning Styles	20	As written.
1:07	Exercise: Teach One Concept Three Ways	20	As written.
1:27	Talk: Hilderbrand Pelzer III, <i>What incarcerated youth can teach teachers</i>	19	Introduce it in one sentence: "He ran a school inside a jail. Listen for what the young people there could have taught the people who taught them to read."
1:46	Talk discussion	4	One or two questions from below, answered by two or three men.
1:50	Closing circle	10	As written. The talk leads straight into the closing question, <i>What's one thing about how YOU learn that you wish your teachers had known when you were younger?</i>

Questions for *What incarcerated youth can teach teachers*

1. He calls young people behind bars "thought partners" for their teachers. What could a man who struggled in school teach you about how to teach him?
2. Think of the young people in the talk. Which of Knowles' four principles would have made the biggest difference for them?
3. The guide says understanding your audience matters more than knowing your content. Where did you see that in the talk?
4. What's one thing about how you learn that a teacher could have found out just by asking you?

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *What incarcerated youth can teach teachers* (Hilderbrand Pelzer III, TEDxDeerPark) — **YouTube** (TEDx Talks): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n-PWRcP60lo> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/hilderbrand_pelzer_iii_what_incarcerated_youth_can_teach_teachers

Preview before class. TED has no transcript of this talk, so we transcribed it ourselves (September 2026): no profanity and no description of offenses or violence. A former principal of schools for incarcerated youth argues that teachers should learn from students who failed at reading, and tells of a 55-year-old man who asked him for help getting his GED. It closes on the high rate at which Black children are incarcerated. It is 18 minutes, mostly about reading instruction; watch it once to judge the fit.

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Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 40A and 40B and the talk loaded on the playback device and tested with sound

- ☐ Talk previewed in full and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ "4 Adult Learning Principles" handout ready (from the guide's materials list)